



Restaurant Training Checklist

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Description Of Training	Date	Training Objectives	Trainee's Signature	Trainer's Signature
Introduction to Restaurant: Show around of restaurant(s) Introduction to – ○ Head of Department ○ Mentor/Trainer ○ Other Team Members Show around of kitchen ○ Pastry ○ Starters ○ Hot Plate ○ Dry Stores/Fridges ○ Stillroom/Wash-up				
Restaurant Set-up ○ Breakfast ○ Lunch ○ Dinner ○ Buffet ○ Handling cutlery ○ Cleaning/Polishing glasses ○ Placing/removing Tablecloths ○ Napkin folds ○ Centrepieces ○ Identification of Crockery ○ Stillroom Set up ○ Show around linen area				
Guest Interaction and Personalisation				

Guest Greeting and Seating: Proper etiquette for greeting guests, taking reservations, and seating them according to their preferences (e.g., window seating, quiet areas). Personalising Service: Tailoring service to frequent or VIP guests, remembering preferences, special requests, or dietary restrictions to enhance guest experience. Handling Special Requests: How to handle special guest requests such as customised dishes, food allergies, or special occasions (e.g., birthdays, anniversaries). Handling VIP Guests: Special procedures for serving VIP guests, including discrete service, customisation of meals, and communication with the kitchen and management.				
Event Planning and Execution Special Event Setup: Procedures for setting up for special events such as weddings, corporate functions, and private parties, including room layout, table settings, and decor. Event Coordination: Training on coordinating with other departments (e.g., kitchen, banquet team, and bar) to ensure seamless execution of events. Menu Customisation for Events: Understanding how to offer and explain special menus for events, including fixed menus, buffets, or family-style service.				
Restaurant Layout and Table Management Table Management Systems: Training on how to use digital table management systems (if available) to track table availability, wait times, and reservations.				

Optimising Table Layout: Understanding how to arrange tables to optimise flow, guest comfort, and operational efficiency, including set-ups for private events or large groups. Seating Rotation and Management: Techniques for managing the seating of guests to ensure fair distribution of tables among servers and avoid overburdening employees. Table Numbers				
Technology and Digital Systems Point of Sale (POS) Systems: Mastery of the restaurant’s POS system, including taking orders, splitting checks, applying discounts, processing payments, and handling refunds. Digital Ordering Systems: Training on digital ordering tools (e.g., tablets, mobile apps) if used in the restaurant for guest ordering or table-side service. Reservation Systems: Training on digital reservation systems, including managing bookings, special requests, and waitlists.				
Compliance with Health, Safety, and Hygiene Standards Food Safety and Hygiene (HACCP): In-depth training on the Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points (HACCP) system, including safe food handling, personal hygiene, and kitchen sanitation. Allergen Awareness: Understanding common food allergens, how to handle guest inquiries about allergens, and the importance of preventing cross-contamination. Fire and Safety Procedures: Understanding emergency procedures, including fire exits, evacuation routes, and the location of fire extinguishers in the restaurant.				

Manual Handling and Lifting: Proper techniques for lifting heavy trays, chairs, or furniture to avoid injury. Location of First Aid Boxes. Handling cleaning materials.				
Presentation and Service of Food and Beverages Food Presentation Standards: Ensuring consistency in food presentation, how to properly present and describe dishes to guests. Serving Wine: Advanced training on the presentation, opening, decanting, and serving of wine, including proper glassware and handling. Cocktail Service: Knowledge of signature or classic cocktails, including proper glassware, garnishes, and how to describe these drinks to guests. Coffee and Tea Service: Procedures for serving speciality teas and coffees, including the proper preparation and presentation of drinks such as espressos, cappuccinos, and lattes.				
Payment Processing Protocols Completing Guests account. Presenting the bill. Processing payment ○ Cash ○ Credit card ○ Charge to room/Company account (including verifying room numbers) ○ Gift Card/Vouchers/promotional discounts How to access change/float				

Tipping Procedures Cash tips: Keeping a record of cash tips left during service and ensuring they are distributed fairly among team members according to the hotel's/Guesthouse's tipping policy. Credit card tips: Understanding how tips added to credit card transactions are processed and included in end-of-shift reconciliation.				
Wine and Beverage Knowledge Wine Varietals and Regions: Training on various wine types (red, white, rosé), key wine-producing regions, and how to recommend wines based on guest preferences. Beer Knowledge: Understanding different types of beer (lagers, ales, stouts) and local craft beer options, and how to suggest appropriate pairings with menu items. Spirits and Liquor Knowledge: Familiarity with popular spirits, including whiskey (especially Irish whiskey), gin, vodka, and rum, as well as their uses in cocktails and straight pours.				
Food and Beverage Product Knowledge Detailed Menu Knowledge: In-depth understanding of all menu items, including ingredients, preparation methods, dietary considerations (e.g., gluten-free, vegan, allergens), and origins of key ingredients (especially locally sourced products). Wine and Beverage Pairing: Knowledge of pairing wines, beers, and cocktails with food items to enhance the dining experience, including suggestions based on guest preferences.				

Daily Specials and Promotions: Clear understanding of any daily specials, promotions, or seasonal menu items, including their preparation, pricing, and potential upselling opportunities. Local and Artisan Products: Information on any local or artisanal products featured on the menu, allowing employees to share the story behind these items with guests.				
Catering to Dietary Restrictions and Preferences Handling Special Dietary Needs: Training on how to handle guest requests for gluten-free, vegan, vegetarian, or low-sodium options, ensuring kitchen communication is clear. Cross-Contamination Prevention: Ensuring employees understand how to prevent cross-contamination when handling orders for guests with severe food allergies. Menu Customisation: Training on how to adjust or recommend menu items to accommodate special dietary needs while still providing an enjoyable dining experience.				
Upselling Techniques Menu Upselling: Training employees on effective techniques for upselling appetizers, premium dishes, beverages, and desserts without being pushy or overbearing. Beverage Upselling: Encouraging the sale of premium wines, spirits, or speciality cocktails by offering recommendations based on guest preferences or food pairings. Promoting Special Events: Informing guests about upcoming special events, promotions, or seasonal menus to encourage return visits.				
Handling Difficult Situations and Guest Complaints				

Dealing with Complaints: Techniques for handling guest complaints professionally and efficiently, including how to resolve issues on the spot or escalate them when necessary. Managing Difficult Guests: Training on how to remain calm and professional when dealing with difficult or demanding guests, including conflict resolution techniques. Handling Intoxicated Guests: Procedures for managing guests who appear to be intoxicated, including how to refuse service while maintaining professionalism and following licensing laws.				
Teamwork and Communication Interdepartmental Communication: Training on communicating effectively with the kitchen, bar, and front desk to ensure seamless service and a unified guest experience. Shift Handover Procedures: Clear procedures for handing over tasks, notes, and responsibilities between shifts to ensure continuity in service quality. Efficient Teamwork: Training on how to support colleagues during busy periods, including sharing responsibilities, clearing tables, and assisting with order delivery.				
Restaurant Cleanliness and Maintenance Cleaning Schedules: Training on daily, weekly, and deep cleaning schedules for the dining area, bar, and service stations to maintain hygiene standards. Table Setting and Resetting: Proper procedures for setting and resetting tables quickly and correctly, ensuring consistency and attention to detail.				

Furniture Care and Maintenance: How to maintain restaurant furniture, including cleaning upholstery, polishing wooden furniture, and reporting any necessary repairs.				
Cultural Awareness and Sensitivity Cultural Sensitivity: Understanding cultural differences in dining habits, guest preferences, and expectations, particularly when dealing with international guests. Language Skills: Basic training in foreign languages or hospitality phrases (especially for international guests) or offering menus in multiple languages if applicable.				
Emergency Situations Medical Emergencies: Procedures for handling medical emergencies in the dining area, including who to notify and how to provide immediate assistance until help arrives. Evacuation Procedures: Ensuring team is familiar with fire exits, evacuation routes, and guest safety protocols in case of an emergency				